

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

ethan@staffroomai.com | (512) 694-4844 | GitHub

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing about the founding Forward Deployed Engineer role in San Francisco. For three years I have owned the technical customer relationship after the sale: I embed with the operating team, build production integrations on their data, and stay until the workflow actually changes. I live in Emeryville, so the office days are a short commute.

Rowspace deploys into the customer's environment, keeps their data under their control, and turns messy proprietary data, memos, models, research, accounting, and trade files, into intelligence investors can act on. I want that work. Your own writing is clear that finance is not a domain where mostly right is good enough. I already build so the customer owns the workflow, and I do not ship a pipeline whose output I cannot measure.

What I would do in the seat:

- **Custom pipelines on messy data:** I modernized a data-ingestion pipeline on inconsistent source formats (throughput +99.8%, cost -86%) and built ingestion over unstructured federal case documents into a client-facing dashboard.
- **LLM performance in production:** I designed a content-scoring evaluation from a client's ground truth and held a 95% human-agreement bar. Daily tools are Python, SQL, Claude Code, MCP, and LLM APIs. I do not train foundation models. I debug the production workflow when output disagrees with reviewers.
- **One customer into a playbook:** I automated an IT MSP's pre-sales risk assessments, cut processing time 98%, then trained their team to keep extending it. The pattern I want to keep is: ship the fix, then make it reusable.
- **Translate both ways:** two years in IBM Customer Support shipping DRE Bot, a Watson NLP retrieval app in the Slack channel engineers already used, cutting common issues to a single response, plus release notes for non-technical stakeholders.

One real gap, named plainly: I have not held a titled Forward Deployed Engineer role, and I have not sat inside an investment firm. Excel tearsheets, PE due diligence, and fund warehouses are a plus I cannot claim. What I have done is the adjacent work: unstructured documents, inconsistent formats, and production LLM systems where accuracy is the product. I would bring that as a founder joining a team.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about how you turn one customer's integration into the next firm's default.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker